



Elder Mind

Agentic Governance

by Cyber Elders

User Guide

Install, configure, and operate the Elder Mind Governance Harness.

Not a command-line person? You don't need to be. Ask your AI assistant to *"install the Elder Mind governance harness and set it up for me"* — Elder Mind is designed to be installed **by** the agent it will govern. The steps below are exactly what it does on your behalf, so you can follow along or do them yourself.

1 • INSTALL

Pre-release (from source); becomes `pipx install eldermind` once published:

```
git clone <repo> && cd elder-mind-harness && pipx install .  
eldermind init claude-code # guided setup – or opencode | kiro | cursor
```

2 • GUIDED SETUP

`eldermind init` walks you (and your agent) through: which harness, a governance tier, whether to enable supply-chain protection, and which models the council may use. It writes `.eldermind/` and wires the pre-tool hook.

3 • GOVERNANCE TIERS

Tier	Behaviour
explorer	Low friction — ask→warn, but a hard block is never relaxed. Learning.
practitioner	Sensible default — knowledge-worker safe prototyping.
governed	Stricter — warn→ask.
operator	Strictest — warn→ask, ask→block.

4 • ENFORCEMENT BY IDE

IDE	Enforcement
Claude Code	Hard block (PreToolUse) · Win / macOS / Linux

OpenCode	Hard block (tool.execute.before) · Win / macOS / Linux
Kiro	Hard block (preToolUse) · Win / macOS / Linux
Cursor + any MCP client	Advisory (call govern_check) · Win / macOS / Linux

5 · COMMANDS

Command	Purpose
init / install	Wire the harness into a tool (guided or non-interactive).
check '<json>'	Evaluate a tool call (the hook target). Exit 0 allow/warn, 2 ask/block.
scan <cmd lockfile>	Supply-chain check (OSV).
explain <id>	Reconstruct a past decision from the audit log.
verify	Confirm the audit chain is intact (tamper-evident).
pin <list check reset>	Pin tool/MCP descriptors and detect drift.
serve / summary	Advisory MCP server · audit aggregate metrics.

6 · WHAT IT DOES NOT DO

Not a prompt-injection classifier, OS sandbox, full SCA, or multi-agent monitor — pair it with the right tool for those. The gate only sees calls the harness routes through its hook. See THREAT_MODEL.md.